

HILLARY ADARE — GLOBAL TALENT (DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY)

Exceptional Talent vs Exceptional Promise — Case Comparison

This document builds the case for both endorsement tiers side by side, using only evidence already confirmed. Each criterion match is labelled STRONG, MODERATE, or WEAK based on how directly the available evidence supports it — these labels are working assessments for her and any advisor to test, not a guarantee of Tech Nation's decision.

Case A — Exceptional Talent (Leader)

Requirement: recognised by others as a leading talent in digital technology within the last 5 years, plus at least 2 of the 5 listed criteria, evidenced as already achieved.

Recognition evidence

- **[MODERATE]** Mandela Washington Fellow (2023), Chevening Scholar (2025), 10 Faces Changing Africa Award (2024), Womenpreneur Tour Africa (2024). These are genuine, internationally competitive honours — but each is explicitly positioned as recognising emerging or future leaders, not established ones, which is a weaker match to the "leading talent" wording this tier requires.
- **[WEAK]** 2026 Schöffel Countryside Awards and Farmers Weekly Awards nominations. Nominee status, not a win — limited evidentiary weight either way.

Criterion 1 — Record of innovation as founder/senior executive

- **[STRONG]** Founder & CEO of Wonfliki since 2019 (7 years). AI/ML and GIS-based product (NDVI analysis, yield prediction, pest risk modelling). \$25,000 Absa–Mastercard Foundation grant secured (2023). Service coverage expanded to 15,000+ acres through new client acquisition.

Criterion 3 — Contribution to the sector outside work

- **[STRONG]** Adwumawura Programme (Government of Ghana) — capacity building with youth/participants in Bole and Sawla districts, with participants subsequently securing government funding. Farmer and Youth Skill Training Project across 4 districts. LINC-funded training of ~20 farmers across 2 districts in the Eastern Region.

Criterion 5 — Research published or endorsed by an expert

- **[WEAK]** The one published paper (3-D Biostereometrics Modeling for Reconstructive Surgery) is biomedical, not digital technology — unlikely to count toward this criterion for this route.

Where this case is exposed

- No disclosed revenue, employee headcount, or funding round beyond the \$25,000 grant — thinner than typical Leader-tier benchmarks.
- Her own headline recognition is fellowship-framed as "emerging," which an assessor could read as evidence against, not for, established leadership.
- If recommenders cannot credibly describe her as already a leading figure in the sector (rather than a highly promising one), this tier is difficult to sustain.

Case B — Exceptional Promise (Potential Leader)

Requirement: recognised by others as having the potential to become a leading talent, plus the same 2 of 5 criteria — evidenced with the softer "can show" standard.

Recognition evidence

- **[STRONG]** The same fellowships now work in her favour rather than against her: Mandela Washington and Chevening are both explicitly "emerging/future leader" credentials, which is a direct linguistic and substantive match for this tier's recognition standard.

Criterion 1 — Innovation as founder

- **[STRONG]** Identical evidence to Case A (Wonfliki's AI/ML/GIS product, the \$25,000 grant, the 15,000-acre expansion) — comfortably clears the softer "can show innovation" bar for this tier.

Criterion 3 — Contribution outside work

- **[STRONG]** Identical evidence to Case A (Adwumawura, Farmer and Youth Skill Training, LINC training) — again comfortably sufficient under the softer standard.

Where this case is exposed

- 7 years as a founder is longer than the "likely under 5 years" profile GOV.UK describes for this tier — worth a recommender explicitly addressing why Wonfliki is still at a scaling, not established, stage.
- Settlement takes 5 years instead of 3 — a real cost if she is confident in the stronger case.

Side-by-Side Verdict

Factor	Exceptional Talent (Leader)	Exceptional Promise (Potential Leader)
Recognition threshold	Must be recognised as an already-arrived leading talent	Must be recognised as having the potential to become one — a lower bar
Fit with fellowships held	Weaker fit — Mandela Washington and Chevening are explicitly framed as emerging/future-leader programmes, not established-leader recognition	Strong fit — the fellowships' own language ("emerging", "future leader") maps directly onto this tier's wording
Scale evidence (\$25k grant, 15,000 acres, ~20 farmers)	Helpful, but modest next to typical Leader-tier benchmarks (larger funding rounds, disclosed revenue, headcount)	Comfortably strong for this tier — clearly shows innovation and traction without needing to prove market leadership
Years of experience	7 years as founder technically clears the tier's usual experience level	Guidance allows longer careers here too, provided the company is still scaling rather than established — defensible for Wonfliki's stage
Refusal risk	Higher — assessor discretion on whether she is already a "leader" is the main exposure point	Lower — evidence more comfortably clears the bar as currently documented
Path to settlement (ILR)	3 years	5 years
Working recommendation	Only if stronger scale evidence (funding, revenue, headcount) is secured before submission	Current default — best evidence-to-risk fit given what is documented today

Bottom line

As the evidence stands today, Exceptional Promise is the stronger, lower-risk case — her clearest evidence (the fellowships, the \$25,000 grant, the acreage expansion) fits this tier's standard more precisely than it fits Leader-tier's "already arrived" bar. This is a working conclusion, not a final one: if she can add a disclosed funding round, revenue figures, or employee headcount before the recommendation letters are finalised, it's worth revisiting Exceptional Talent, since it carries a materially faster path to settlement.